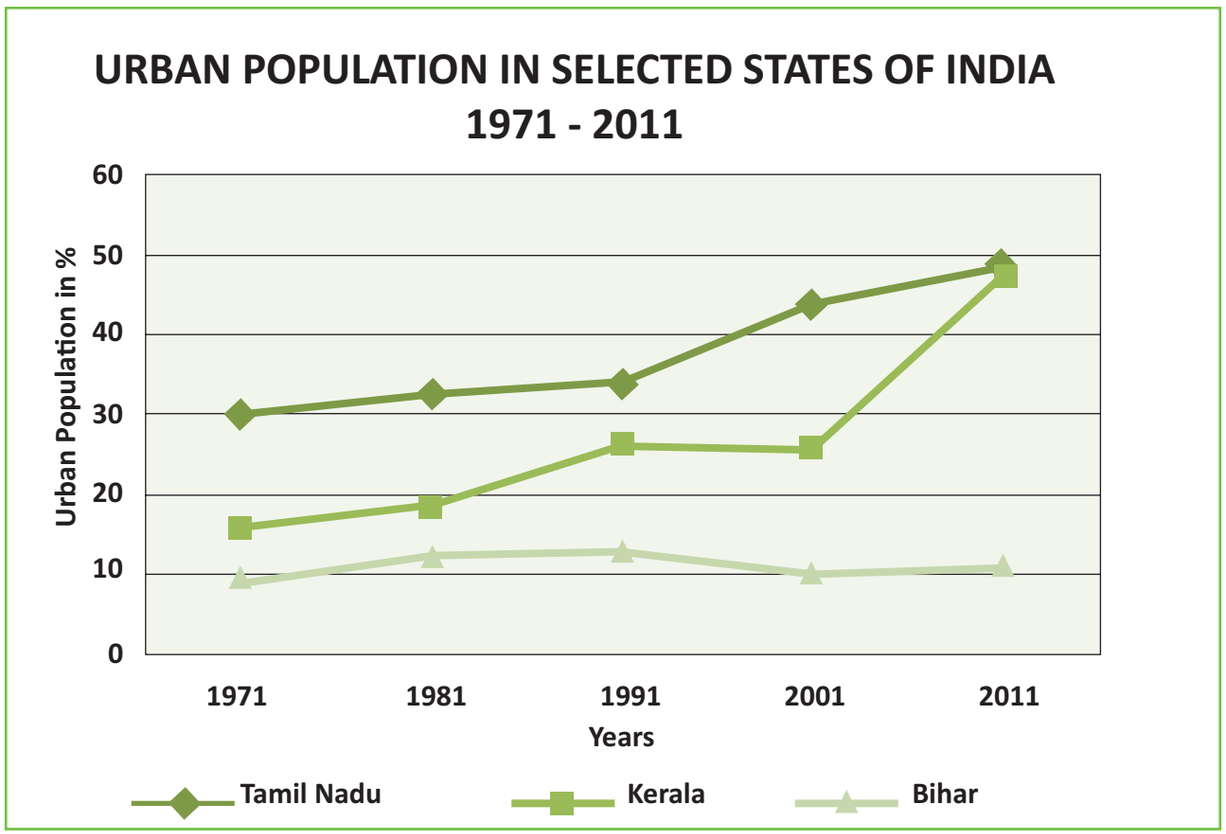


Polygraph

12.2.2 Bar Diagram

In Bar diagrams quantities are represented by bars, the length of which are proportional to the quantities, they represent. The diagrams which represent quantities by bars are known as bar diagrams, columnar diagrams or bar-graphs. When compared with other diagrams, the bar diagram gives more accurate idea of the size of the quantities represented by them. They are also drawn on maps for showing regional variations in the distribution of a quantity. The bars are either vertical or horizontal.

- The width of all the bars or columns should be similar.
- All the bars should be placed on intervals of equal distance.
- Bars may be shaded with colours or patterns to make them distinct and attractive.

Kinds of Bar Diagrams

1. Simple bar diagram.
2. Comparative or multiple bar diagram.
3. Compound or sub-divided bar diagram.
4. Percentage bar diagram.

We shall discuss Simple Bar Diagram and Multiple Bar Diagram in this unit.

Simple Bar Diagram

A simple bar diagram consists of a series of bars each of which shows total value of only one variable. We can represent for example the total population of different states of a country for a particular year, the annual production of wheat, rice, cotton for a particular place etc., and monthly rainfall for 12 months of the year. A simple bar diagram is constructed for an immediate comparison. It is advisable to arrange the given data set in an ascending or descending order and plot the data variables accordingly.

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